

Swagger Codegen Reference - v3

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Swagger Codegen CLI — general options (v3)

Swagger Codegen 3.x uses Maven group id io.swagger.codegen.v3 and supports OpenAPI 3.0.x specs (2.x does not).

Getting the CLI

```
wget https://repo1.maven.org/maven2/io/swagger/codegen/v3/swagger-codegen-cli/3.0.71/\
swagger-codegen-cli-3.0.71.jar -O swagger-codegen-cli.jar
```

Running

```
java -jar swagger-codegen-cli.jar generate \
-i https://petstore.swagger.io/v3/swagger.json \
-l php \
-o /tmp/php_api_client
```

Flag reference

Flag	Description	Present in v2?
-i	Spec location, URL or file.	Yes
-l	Target language.	Yes
-o	Output directory.	Yes
-c	JSON config file path.	Yes
--generate-markdown	New in v3 — generates a standalone markdown API doc alongside client code.	No
-DhideGenerationTimestamp=true	Suppresses generation timestamp.	Yes

Note: v3 rejects OpenAPI 2.0 (Swagger) specs by default; use `--verbose` for spec-conversion diagnostics if generation fails unexpectedly on an older spec file.

Compared to v2

In Swagger Codegen 2.x, the equivalent jar was fetched from the `io.swagger` Maven group (not `io.swagger.codegen.v3`), and the same `-i`, `-l`, `-o`, and `-c` flags behaved identically for basic generation. The `--generate-markdown` flag did not exist in 2.x — anyone wanting standalone API documentation in v2 had to generate it separately via a documentation-only generator target (e.g. `-l html2`) rather than getting it alongside client code in the same run.

Java client generator — configuration options (v3)

Overview

The java generator in Swagger Codegen 3.x carries over most 2.x options and adds a handful of new ones related to OpenAPI 3 features (e.g. oneOf/anyOf schema support).

Options table

Option	Type	Default	Description
sortParamsByRequiredFlag	boolean	true	Place required parameters before optional ones.
ensureUniqueParams	boolean	true	Ensure parameter names are unique per operation.
allowUnicodeIdentifiers	boolean	false	Allow unicode identifiers in generated names.
useOneOfInterfaces	boolean	false	New in v3. Generates a Java interface for each OpenAPI oneOf schema.
library	enum	okhttp-gson	Library template. v3 adds native and web client options not present in v2.
modelPackage	string	—	Package for generated models.

Run `config-help -l java` against your v3 CLI jar for the authoritative, version-matched list — v3's list differs from v2's and the two `config-help` outputs should not be assumed interchangeable.

Compared to v2

Swagger Codegen 2.x's java generator documented these same options — `sortParamsByRequiredFlag`, `ensureUniqueParams`, `allowUnicodeIdentifiers`, `library`, `modelPackage` — as a plain bulleted list rather than a table, and defaults for each were written inline in prose, e.g. “(Default: true)”. The `library` option in 2.x only accepted `jersey1`, `jersey2`, `feign`, `okhttp-gson`, `retrofit`, `retrofit2`, and `resteasy`; `native` and `webclient` did not exist as choices, and `useOneOfInterfaces` had no equivalent at all since OpenAPI 2.0 specs (which v2 of the tool targets) have no `oneOf` construct.

Python generator — config options

v3 notes

Same core options as v2's python generator, plus library selection between urllib3 (default, unchanged) and asyncio (new in v3, generates async/await client methods).

Option	Default	Notes
packageName	swagger_client	Unchanged from v2.
projectName	derived from packageName	Unchanged.
packageVersion	1.0.0	Unchanged.
library	urllib3	v3 adds asyncio as a selectable value.
sortParamsByRequiredFlag	true	Unchanged.

```
{  
  "packageName": "petstore_api",  
  "library": "asyncio"  
}
```

Generated code differs meaningfully when library=asyncio is set — calling code must await API methods rather than call them synchronously.

Compared to v2

The v2 python generator documented packageName, projectName, and packageVersion the same way — as plain key/description text rather than a table — but had no library option at all; every generated client used what v3 now calls the urllib3 behavior, since it was the only option available. There was consequently no asyncio choice and no async/await generated code path in 2.x.

The .swagger-codegen-ignore file (v3)

Behaves as in 2.x, with one addition: v3 also honors a .openapi-generator-ignore-style negation pattern (!pattern) to re-include a file that a broader glob above it excluded — this negation support did not exist in 2.x.

```
# Ignore everything in docs/  
docs/**/*
```

```
# ...except this one file  
!docs/keep-this.md
```

As in v2, place the file in the output directory root before running generate. Rules are read once per invocation.

Compared to v2

Swagger Codegen 2.x's .swagger-codegen-ignore file supported only plain glob-style exclude patterns, matching .gitignore syntax exactly. There was no way to re-include a file once a broader pattern above it had excluded it — if you wrote docs/**/* to skip a folder in v2, every file underneath was skipped with no override mechanism, which was a frequently reported limitation for users who wanted to exclude most of a generated folder but keep one hand-edited file.

Config file usage (v3)

How it works

Same `-c config.json` mechanism as v2. v3 additionally allows a `.yaml` config file (auto-detected by extension) as an alternative to JSON, and supports a top-level `additionalProperties` key that nests language-specific values instead of listing them flat.

Supported keys

Key	Type	v2 equivalent	Notes
<code>modelPackage</code>	string	same	Unchanged.
<code>apiPackage</code>	string	same	Unchanged.
<code>invokerPackage</code>	string	same	Unchanged.
<code>groupId / artifactId / artifactVersion</code>	string	same	Unchanged, Maven-target languages only.
<code>additionalProperties</code>	object	(new)	Nests generator-specific options; if present, flat top-level keys of the same name are ignored in favor of the nested value.

```
modelPackage: com.example.model
additionalProperties:
  library: asyncio
```

```
java -jar swagger-codegen-cli.jar generate -i spec.yaml -l python -c config.yaml
```

Compared to v2

The v2 config file mechanism accepted JSON only — YAML config files were not recognized, and passing one would fail with a parse error rather than being auto-detected. There was also no `additionalProperties` nesting; every option had to be specified as a flat top-level key, exactly as shown in the v2 example above, which became unwieldy once a generator needed many language-specific overrides in a single config file.